He tied his laces and paced as he checked his list once more;
He was finally going to get the picture of that bird he had been chasing for.
He made his notes, reports of spotting up the hill.
On the stove, the kettle whistled.

30 years, and he had seen them all.
The neighbors called him foolish for the try,
and whispered that his joints were far too frail.

He knew he had prepared with his life,
knew the best way up and down.
His maps told the tale of a prepared man.
For 30 years, he had watched the sun rise from over that hill,
the thin beam that teased him for not trying.

This was the day; he was the man he had to be to make the trip.
The coffee was right; the weather was right and his shoes new.
This was the day he'd stand above the mist and view the dew.